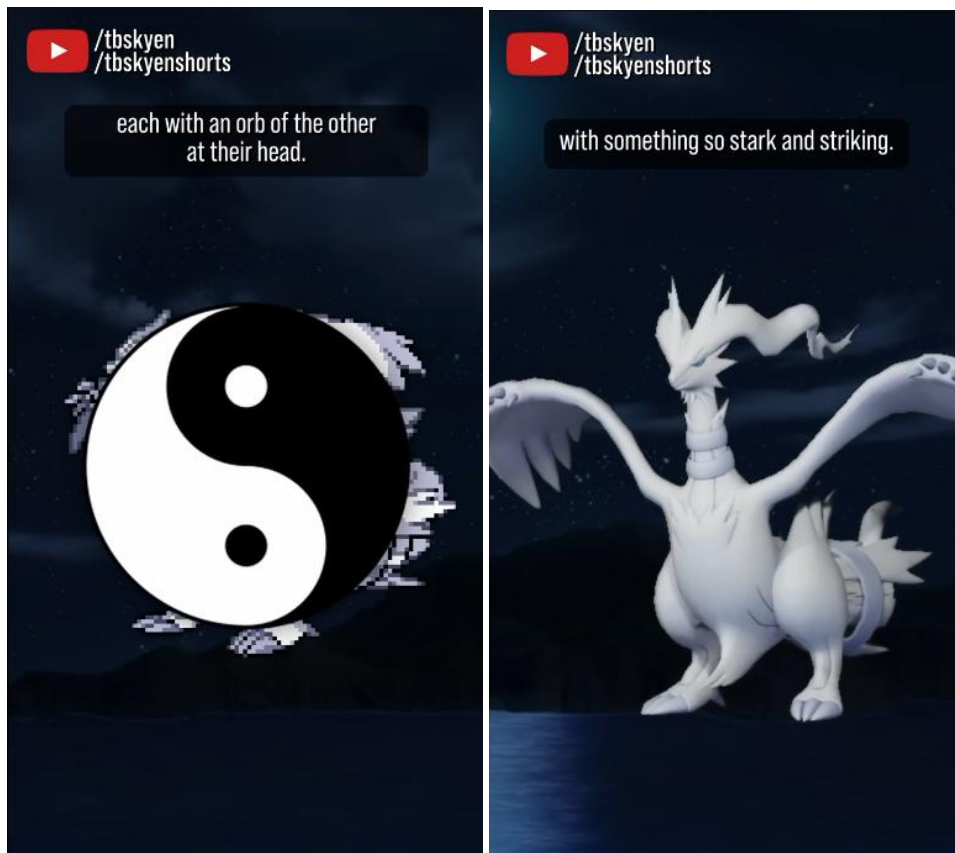


Rhetoric usage in Pokémon Design Analysis

What makes a character design memorable? Is it their silhouette, the color palette, or the hidden story that is shown in its anatomy? In the new age of short form videos, content creators have found a surprisingly reliable format for unpacking these questions, in the means of delivering nuanced design analysis in the 1-to-3-minute range. In TBSkyen's YouTube Short analyzing the Pokémon Reshiram, the creator argues on the deliverance of the design as he references other real-world concepts in a means to solidify his analysis. Through a blend of visual evidence, community knowledge, and a critical tone, the video demonstrates how short form content can be both rhetorically persuasive and still retain some substance, even with the tight constraints. TBSkyen effectively uses rhetorical strategies and persuades viewers by referencing Tao as a major theme of this work and how its intent is meaningful, though the short form content sacrifices the depth needed to fully support the claim.



The video first homes in on the claim that Reshiram and its counterpart Zekrom from the Pokémon Black and White games, are a reference to the Tao; which may not be surprising to say the least. The Tao in this context being referred to as a framework of understanding set in the form of dualities. They are seen as complementary and also the complete opposite as they encircle one another. The creator establishes the narrative that one's role is to find the balance between yin and yang; or in TBSkyen's words, between "male and female, nature and civilization" and, in this case, between black and white. The creator proclaims that Reshiram is meant to represent the white side of the symbol and serves as the complement to Zekrom. This can be seen through visual comparison like Reshiram's design where it is spiky, soft and almost animalistic; while their counter part is smooth, hard, and almost robotic. Later on, he employs logos as he focuses on the designs weakness as while it is stark and striking it "suffers a little bit from a marketing design," which can be seen as the design prioritizes looking superficially cool rather than introducing more of the Yin and Yang aspect. He later concedes that he does not particularly mind this considering their original audience and assigns it the a B in the A-F scale in the description.



Throughout the video, multiple rhetorical strategies are employed to argue for the effectiveness of Reshiram's design. Most notable is the use of ethos to establish TBSkyen's credibility. maintaining a professional tone, even when the content he is analyzing has an audience originally intended for children. This creates the message that the critique being perceived is reliable and consistent compared to a casual fan analysis. The video further builds eths through the rhetorical device of concession; by acknowledging flaws in the design, the creator attempts to maintain a fair and impartial point of view. This is implied when TBSkyen states that the design "has to look superficially cool and elaborate and powerful, and a lot of the details and features on the design feel motivated by *that*" a direct reference to the

aforementioned ‘marketing design’. The duality mentioned earlier also has a structural role showing Reshiram’s more interesting traits and contrasting them against the design given by the Pokémon company, reinforcing the image that while it is a successful design it does have some small shortcomings; that even the creator also enjoys himself.

The constraint of the YouTube Shorts format also has a significant role in shaping the video’s rhetorical approach. Because Shorts are intended for a 1-to-3-minute window, the creator cannot solely rely on detailed logical breakdowns to hold the viewer’s attention. As a result, the video employs pathos; the aspect of appealing to emotions and enthusiasm of the audience. This is done in an attempt to compensate for any depth that the format fails to accommodate. The creator’s tone holds a feeling of appreciation for the design’s original and symbolic roots, which tries to lure viewers who share a connection to Pokémon to eventually feel a similar feeling of discovery. This emotional kinship is more effective in short-form content, where a new viewer’s interest must be captured within seconds not minutes. However, this reliance on pathos also places a highlight the formats base limitation: the emotional appeal can carry the argument so far before the absence of more compelling evidence is noticeable.

Ultimately, TBSkyen’s short-form analysis of Reshiram demonstrates that rhetorical effectiveness does not require an excessive length to be any more convincing. Through the use of ethos, the creator shows their credibility by maintaining a professional tone and conceding any and all major shortcomings, which makes Reshiram’s rating at the end feel earned rather than completely biased. The structural use of the Tao duality not only embodies the analysis thematically but also adds to the logical consistency of the argument throughout the video. While

the YouTube Shorts format does limit how deep any single design choice can be looked at or scrutinized, the combination of these rhetorical strategies helps with the 3-minute runtime. The video succeeds not in spite of any major constraints, but more so because the creator works together with them silently; using credibility, balance, and a focused core argument to deliver an analysis that feels complete. In doing so, TBSkyen shows a case that short-form content, when handled constructively and is concise, can be capable of carrying genuine analytical weight.

Work Cited

TBSkyen [@TBSkyenShorts]. (2026, June 7). *Reshiram is VERY interesting, but a bit messy.*
#pokemon [Video]. YouTube Shorts. <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/qUizpA9X1OE>